

Lyra — Getting Started (Quick Basics)

The five-minute on-ramp. Brand new to Lyra? Do these in order and you'll be listening — and talking — fast. Everything here is covered in more depth in the in-app Help guide.

Currently supported

Lyra is a native Windows application.

- Windows 10 (64-bit, v1809 or newer) or Windows 11 — 32-bit is not supported.
- A DirectX 11 / OpenGL 3.3-capable GPU (built-in graphics are fine).
- A wired Ethernet connection to the radio — this is the single biggest factor in glitch-free audio.
- A Hermes Lite 2 or 2+ (HL2 / HL2+).

(Full detail is in the Help guide under "System requirements". Linux/macOS are on the roadmap but do not run today.)

1 — Wire it up

- Connect the Hermes Lite to your PC with an Ethernet cable. Wired, not Wi-Fi — Wi-Fi in the radio path is the most common cause of pops and dropouts.
- Power the radio on.

2 — Launch & connect

- Open Lyra. It scans the network and lists any radio it finds.
- Double-click your radio in the list to open it.
- On a fixed IP or a different subnet? Use Add by IP and type the radio's address.

(First launch only: Lyra spends a few minutes tuning its DSP math to your CPU — a one-time step. Let it finish; it opens by itself.)

3 — Start the radio

- Click Start in the top header. The spectrum comes alive.

4 — Hear a signal

- Open Settings → Audio → Out and pick where you listen:
 - "HL2 audio jack (AK4951)" — headphones plugged into the radio, or
 - your PC speakers / headset.
- Turn the Volume up.
- Click on the panadapter or the waterfall to tune to a signal, and set the mode — SSB (USB above 10 MHz, LSB below), or AM / FM.

5 — Talk

- See First voice setup (SSB / AM / FM) in the Help guide — it walks the microphone and PTT in a couple of steps, for a mic on the radio or on the PC.
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If something's not working

- No radio found → check the wired cable and that the radio is powered.

Wi-Fi and sleeping network adapters are the usual culprits.

- No audio → check Settings → Audio → Out (right device?) and the Volume.

- Can't transmit → see First voice setup — most first-time TX problems are the mic not set up in Windows, or the wrong Mic source in Lyra.

Where to go next

Everything lives in the in-app Help guide (open it from the Help menu, or the cyan ? on any panel):

- First voice setup — your first phone contact, step by step.
- The panadapter, Tuning, Filters, Band, Audio panels — the day-to-day controls.
- Settings — audio devices, TX, CW, CAT, network, and more.
- Session recorder — capture RX audio + snapshots and turn them into a video.

Welcome aboard, and 73.